revisionism, either through infrastructure building or an advanced military presence, even while appearing to negotiate diplomatically. These activities have included frequent naval patrols in disputed areas and the extension of an Air Defence Identification Zone over the East China Sea around the Senkaku Islands controlled by Japan (which China calls the Diaoyu Islands). In the South China Sea, China has built artificial islands and imported military equipment—including surface-to-air missiles and electronic jammers—to stake claim to the surrounding international waters and airspace. It has used its maritime militia, coast guard, and navy to intimidate civilian and military vessels belonging to other claimant states, including the Philippines, Vietnam, and Malaysia. [9] In the Himalayas, infrastructure activity and encroachments by ground forces have represented attempts to expand Chinese control over territory it disputes with India and Bhutan. In short, despite claims of a peaceful rise, China's ascent as a global power has been accompanied by much more assertive behaviour, on its borders and beyond. [10]

A fourth reason to be concerned about China's rise is that it has frequently contravened certain established international norms. For example, prior to signing the nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty (NPT), China transferred weapon-grade uranium and sensitive nuclear technology to Pakistan to build nuclear weapons. More recently, it provided Pakistan with nuclear reactors in violation of its Nuclear Suppliers Group (NSG) commitments. Similarly, China ignored international arbitration over its territorial claims in the South China Sea, despite falling within the jurisdiction of the ruling as a signatory of the United Nations Convention on the Law of the Sea (UNCLOS). It has tested the boundaries of the Antarctic Treaty system and conducted anti-satellite tests at low altitudes, contributing greatly to debris in space. [11] Obviously, China is not the only country to have flouted rules and norms. But the fact that China is a rising global power means that its unwillingness to abide by these international conventions represents a distinct challenge to those countries—like India—that do broadly ascribe to them. [12]